

D098

Digital Marketing

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A regional HVAC company with a five-star Google rating wants to appear in search results for “furnace repair” within the next week, because a cold snap is forecast. Its website was redesigned last year by an award-winning agency. Which approach fits the one-week timeline?

- A. Pay the search engine to move the site to the top of organic results.
- B. Run a paid search (PPC) campaign on “furnace repair” keywords.
- C. Publish new SEO blog posts about furnace repair.
- D. Rely on the award-winning site design to rank on its own.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

An online shoe store’s spring ad ran on a sports news site with 2 million monthly readers. The ad received 200,000 impressions and 3,000 clicks, and 90 of those visitors bought shoes. What was the conversion rate?

- A. 3%
- B. 1.5%
- C. 0.045%
- D. 33.3%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A campaign has a 1% click-through rate and a 2.5% conversion rate. How many impressions are needed to get 150 sales?

- A. 600,000
- B. 6,000
- C. 15,000
- D. 60

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A skincare brand spent \$5,000 on social ads last month. The ads produced 250 purchases with an average order of \$80. The brand's founder has 40,000 personal followers. What was the return on ad spend (ROAS)?

- A. 4 to 1 (400%)
- B. \$20 per purchase
- C. 0.25 to 1
- D. 3 to 1, counting only revenue above the ad cost

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A marketer can pay up to \$25 per acquisition and wants 400 new customers. What is the most the campaign budget can be?

- A. \$425
- B. \$10,000
- C. \$16
- D. \$25

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A local brewery posts a behind-the-scenes video on its own Instagram account, which has 12,000 followers. The video was filmed on a new camera the owner bought for \$1,500. What type of media is the post?

- A. Paid media, because money was spent on the camera.
- B. Owned media.
- C. Paid media, because Instagram is a third-party platform.
- D. Earned media.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which of the following is earned media for a hotel?

- A. A banner ad on a travel site.
- B. The hotel's monthly email newsletter.
- C. A travel blogger's unpaid review praising the hotel.
- D. A sponsored post from a paid influencer.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A meal-kit company wants more orders from people who have already bought at least three times. Its warehouse moved to a larger building in June. Which tactic best targets this funnel stage?

- A. Advertising the new warehouse's capacity.
- B. Comparison charts against rival meal kits for first-time shoppers.
- C. A loyalty program with personalized reorder emails.
- D. A broad video ad campaign to reach new audiences.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A nonprofit with 30,000 email subscribers wants to test whether a new donation page raises gifts. Its board meets quarterly. Which test design gives a trustworthy answer?

- A. Show the new page this month and compare with last month's donations.
- B. Change the headline, image and button at once to maximize the difference.
- C. Run it until the next quarterly board meeting, then stop regardless of sample size.
- D. Randomly send half of visitors to each version, change only the button text, and run until the result is statistically significant.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

After two days, version B of a landing page converts at 5.2% and version A at 5.0%, with about 300 visitors each. What should the marketer conclude?

- A. Declare B the winner, because it converts better.
- B. End the test and switch to a before/after comparison.
- C. Declare A the winner, because it was the original.
- D. Keep the test running; the difference may be due to chance.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A customer adds a \$120 jacket to her cart on an outdoor retailer's site and leaves without buying. The retailer sponsors a local hiking club. Two hours later she receives an email showing the jacket and a reminder to finish checkout. What is this an example of?

- A.** Earned media.
- B.** A batch-and-blast newsletter.
- C.** Sponsorship marketing.
- D.** A behavior-triggered automated email (cart abandonment).

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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12.

A software firm's pricing page had 4,000 sessions last month. In 1,800 of them, visitors left without viewing another page. The page was redesigned in May by a freelance designer. Using single-page sessions as bounces, what is the bounce rate?

- A.** It cannot be judged until the May redesign has run a full year.
- B.** 55%
- C.** 45%
- D.** 1,800

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

A regional HVAC company ~~with a five-star Google rating~~ wants to appear in search results for “furnace repair” within the next week, because a cold snap is forecast. ~~Its website was redesigned last year by an award-winning agency.~~ Which approach fits the one-week timeline?

Target word: fastest route to search visibility **Decides:** One-week deadline: only paid placement is immediate.

A	Confusion set	Organic rankings cannot be bought; that is what ads are for.
B	Correct	Paid search ads can appear as soon as the campaign is approved.
C	Adjacent category	SEO builds organic rankings over months, not a week.
D	Camouflage	Design quality does not guarantee rankings for a keyword this week.

2. Answer A Concept 2

An online shoe store’s spring ad ran ~~on a sports news site with 2 million monthly readers~~. The ad received 200,000 impressions and 3,000 clicks, and 90 of those visitors bought shoes. What was the conversion rate?

Target word: conversion rate **Decides:** $\text{Conversions} \div \text{clicks} = 90 / 3,000$.

A	Correct	$90 / 3,000 = 0.03$.
B	Confusion set	That is CTR: $3,000 / 200,000$.
C	Adjacent category	Divides purchases by impressions, the wrong base.
D	Inverted operation	Divides clicks by purchases and misreads the ratio.

3. Answer A Concept 2 · transfer

A campaign has a 1% click-through rate and a 2.5% conversion rate. How many impressions are needed to get 150 sales?

Target word: solve backward for impressions **Decides:** $\text{Clicks} = 150 \div 0.025 = 6,000$; $\text{impressions} = 6,000 \div 0.01$.

A	Correct	$150 / 0.025 = 6,000$ clicks; $6,000 / 0.01 = 600,000$ impressions.
B	Dropped element	Stops at clicks and skips the CTR step.
C	Confusion set	Divides sales by CTR, skipping the conversion step.
D	Inverted operation	Multiplies clicks by CTR instead of dividing.

4. Answer A Concept 3

A skincare brand spent \$5,000 on social ads last month. The ads produced 250 purchases with an average order of \$80. ~~The brand’s founder has 40,000 personal followers.~~ What was the return on ad spend (ROAS)?

Target word: ROAS **Decides:** $\text{Revenue} \div \text{spend} = \$20,000 \div \$5,000$.

A	Correct	$250 \times \$80 = \$20,000$; $\$20,000 / \$5,000 = 4$.
B	Adjacent category	That is CPA ($\$5,000 / 250$), not ROAS.
C	Inverted operation	Divides spend by revenue.
D	Confusion set	$(\$20,000 - \$5,000) / \$5,000$ is profit-based ROI, not ROAS.

5. Answer B Concept 3 • transfer

A marketer can pay up to \$25 per acquisition and wants 400 new customers. What is the most the campaign budget can be?

Target word: solve for spend from CPA **Decides:** Spend = CPA × conversions.

A	Confusion set	Adds the two numbers instead of multiplying.
B	Correct	$\$25 \times 400 = \$10,000$.
C	Inverted operation	Divides 400 by 25.
D	Wrong stem number	The per-customer limit, not the budget.

6. Answer B Concept 4

A local brewery posts a behind-the-scenes video on its own Instagram account, which has 12,000 followers. ~~The video was filmed on a new camera the owner bought for \$1,500.~~ What type of media is the post?

Target word: classify the media **Decides:** The brand controls its own account.

A	Camouflage	Paid media means buying placement, not production costs.
B	Correct	Content on channels the brand controls is owned.
C	Adjacent category	The account is the brand's own; no placement was purchased.
D	Confusion set	Earned media is created or shared by others without payment.

7. Answer C Concept 4 • transfer

Which of the following is earned media for a hotel?

Target word: reverse: pick the example **Decides:** Earned = exposure others give without payment.

A	Inverted operation	Clearly paid media.
B	Adjacent category	Owned media.
C	Correct	Third-party coverage the hotel did not pay for.
D	Confusion set	Payment makes it paid media.

8. Answer C Concept 5

A meal-kit company wants more orders from people who have already bought at least three times. ~~Its warehouse moved to a larger building in June.~~ Which tactic best targets this funnel stage?

Target word: match tactic to stage **Decides:** Existing repeat customers = retention/loyalty stage.

A	Camouflage	The warehouse move is not what the stage is about.
B	Confusion set	That targets consideration for prospects.
C	Correct	Retention tactics aim at existing customers.
D	Adjacent category	That is an awareness tactic.

9. Answer D Concept 6

A nonprofit with 30,000 email subscribers wants to test whether a new donation page raises gifts. ~~Its board meets quarterly.~~ Which test design gives a trustworthy answer?

Target word: valid A/B design **Decides:** Change one element, random split, adequate sample.

A	Adjacent category	A before/after comparison mixes in seasonal and other changes.
B	Dropped element	With several changes, you cannot tell which one caused the result.
C	Camouflage	The board calendar does not decide when a test is valid.
D	Correct	One variable, random assignment and enough data give a valid comparison.

10. Answer D Concept 6 • transfer

After two days, version B of a landing page converts at 5.2% and version A at 5.0%, with about 300 visitors each. What should the marketer conclude?

Target word: reverse: judge a result **Decides:** Small gap, small sample — not yet significant.

A	Absolute language	Any higher number is not automatically a real difference.
B	Adjacent category	Before/after is less reliable than a randomized split.
C	Inverted operation	Being the control does not make it better.
D	Correct	A 0.2-point gap on 300 visitors each is far from significant.

11. Answer D Concept 7

A customer adds a \$120 jacket to her cart on an outdoor retailer's site and leaves without buying. ~~The retailer sponsors a local hiking club.~~ Two hours later she receives an email showing the jacket and a reminder to finish checkout. What is this an example of?

Target word: name the practice **Decides:** An email triggered by the customer's own behavior.

A	Confusion set	The retailer sent the email on its own channel.
B	Inverted operation	Blasts go to everyone on a schedule, not in response to one person's action.
C	Camouflage	The hiking club detail is unrelated.
D	Correct	Automation sends a tailored message when an action occurs.

12. Answer C Concept 8

A software firm's pricing page had 4,000 sessions last month. In 1,800 of them, visitors left without viewing another page. ~~The page was redesigned in May by a freelance designer.~~ Using single-page sessions as bounces, what is the bounce rate?

Target word: bounce rate **Decides:** Single-page sessions ÷ total sessions.

A	Camouflage	The redesign date does not change last month's rate.
B	Inverted operation	That is the share of sessions that continued to another page.
C	Correct	$1,800 / 4,000 = 0.45$.
D	Dropped element	The count of bounces, not the rate.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	1	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	9	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	SEO vs. paid search	SEO earns unpaid (organic) rankings through relevant content, technical health and links over time; paid search (PPC) buys ad placement immediately and stops when spending stops.	Thinking you can pay a search engine to rank higher in organic results.	Whether traffic continues without ad spend and how fast results are needed.
2	CTR and conversion rate	CTR = clicks ÷ impressions; conversion rate = conversions ÷ clicks (or visits). Each uses a different base.	Dividing conversions by impressions and calling it conversion rate.	Impressions, clicks and sales all in one stem.
3	Cost and return metrics (CPC, CPA, ROAS)	CPC = spend ÷ clicks; CPA = spend ÷ conversions; ROAS = revenue from ads ÷ ad spend.	Inverting ROAS or using clicks where conversions belong.	Ad spend alongside clicks, conversions, or revenue.
4	Paid, owned and earned media	Paid media is bought (ads); owned media is controlled by the brand (site, email list, social accounts); earned media is publicity others give freely (reviews, shares, press).	Calling a post on the brand's own social account earned media.	Who created or controls the exposure and whether money changed hands.
5	Marketing funnel stages	Awareness, consideration, conversion and retention/loyalty each call for different tactics and metrics.	Measuring an awareness campaign by immediate sales.	The audience's relationship to the brand: never heard of it, comparing, ready to buy, or already a customer.
6	A/B testing	Change one element, randomly split comparable traffic, and wait for a large enough sample to reach statistical significance before declaring a winner.	Changing several things at once or calling a winner on a small, early difference.	Two versions, a small gap, or several simultaneous changes.
7	Marketing automation and lead nurturing	Automation sends the right message when a person's behavior triggers it (for example, an abandoned cart or a content download) and scores leads to route them to sales.	Equating automation with sending the same blast to the whole list on a schedule.	A customer action followed by an automatic, tailored response.
8	Web analytics: bounce rate	Bounce rate (classic definition) = single-page sessions ÷ total sessions (an engagement signal); it is not the same as exit rate or time on site.	Confusing bounce rate with exit rate or with the share of users who leave from any page.	Sessions that viewed only one page.

Course scope (public description): This course provides students with a knowledge of digital marketing and an introduction to specializations within digital marketing. Foundational knowledge in the areas of content marketing, digital advertising, search engine optimization, social media, web development and analysis, and marketing automation is provided. Students gain a broad overview of digital marketing and an opportunity to explore specific areas of specialization within the field of digital marketing to understand how digital marketing is integrated within a firm's overall marketing strategy.